Seminar 2. From Crisis to Contribution: Ukraine's Role in Advancing Health Diplomacy

Wednesday, 4 November 2026 · 13:00–15:30 CET (14:00–16:30 EEST) · Online seminar (Zoom) · English

Concept

The first seminar established the foundations: what health diplomacy is and why it matters for the region. This seminar takes a step further — from concept to agency.

Ukraine is generating knowledge that exists nowhere else: in health system resilience under pressure, crisis management, and academic continuity during conflict. The seminar aims to make this knowledge visible and legible to an international audience — and to examine the role of academic partnerships as an instrument of diplomacy.

The Paradox

During Seminar 1, a question was raised that remained unanswered. Prof. Hulchiy will open this seminar by returning to it — as a recap of what was discussed and as a frame for what follows.

This seminar is built around a paradox — or perhaps two sides of the same question:

Why does a country under daily attack choose to become a security donor?
(What drives a nation to give when it is under threat?)

How can a country in acute need contribute anything to others at all?
(Where does the capacity come from?)

You don't have to choose one. But by the end of today, we hope you'll have your own answer.

Programme

Time	Block	Who
10 min	**Recap from Seminar 1 + The Paradox** Key findings from the first seminar and the two questions that frame the discussion ahead.	Prof. Olesya Hulchiy
20 min	**Ukraine from the inside: what the system looks like under pressure** Three perspectives in one narrative: clinician, administrator, academic. What the health system goes through during war — and what that experience looks like from the outside.	Prof. Serhiy Dubrov
20 min	**From emergency response to health diplomacy: a regional perspective**	Prof. Dorit Nitzan
10 min	**Looking ahead: questions on the horizon for academic health diplomacy** A youth perspective — her own path into the field, the work of the Youth Council, and what international cooperation looks like from where she stands.	Natalia Pidmurniak
45–50 min	**Panel discussion** Moderated by Prof. Olesya Hulchiy around 2–3 focus questions, drawn from participants' questions submitted in advance. Speakers + floor.	All speakers + participants
5–10 min	**Closing** Key takeaways. Next steps within Health Bridge.	Prof. Olesya Hulchiy

Organized by Health Bridge — a collaboration between Karolinska Institutet, Bogomolets National Medical University, the National University of Life and Environmental Sciences of Ukraine and the University of Latvia — funded by the Swedish Institute.

Funded by Swedish Institute